

Canada's Food Guide

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1. Foundation of Healthy Eating

Healthy eating is more than the foods you eat. It is also about where, when, why and how you eat. Be mindful of your eating habits. Take time to eat and notice when you are hungry and when you are full. Cook more often. Cooking more often can help you develop healthy eating habits. Plan what you eat and involve others in planning and preparing meals. Enjoy your food. Culture and food traditions can be a part of healthy eating.

2. Eat Plenty of Vegetables and Fruits

Vegetables and fruits should make up half of your plate. They are packed with essential vitamins, minerals, and dietary fiber, which are important for overall health and reducing the risk of cardiovascular diseases. Choose a variety of colors and types, including dark green leafy vegetables, orange vegetables like carrots and sweet potatoes. Fresh, frozen, and canned vegetables and fruits are all healthy options, provided they have little to no added sodium or sugar.

3. Choose Whole Grain Foods

Whole grain foods should make up one quarter of your plate. They include whole grain bread, brown rice, whole wheat pasta, quinoa, and oatmeal. Whole grain foods have more fiber than refined grains. Eating a high-fiber diet can help lower the risk of stroke, colon cancer, heart disease, and type 2 diabetes.

4. Consume Protein Foods

Protein foods should make up one quarter of your plate. Protein foods include legumes, nuts, seeds, tofu, fortified soy beverage, fish, shellfish, eggs, poultry, lean red meat including wild game, lower fat milk, lower fat yogurts, lower fat kefir, and cheeses lower in fat and sodium. Choose protein foods that come from plants more often. Plant-based protein foods can provide more fiber and less saturated fat than other types of protein foods. This can be beneficial for heart health.

5. Limit Highly Processed Foods

Limit highly processed foods. If you choose these foods, eat them less often and in small amounts. Highly processed foods are processed or prepared foods and drinks that add excess sodium, sugars, or saturated fat to the diets of Canadians. Examples include sugary drinks, chocolate and candies, ice cream and frozen desserts, fast food, bakery products like muffins and cakes, and processed meats like sausages and deli meats.

6. Make Water Your Drink of Choice

Water supports health and promotes hydration without adding calories to the diet. It is essential for metabolic processes and helps the body function efficiently. There are many ways to enjoy water. Try it hot or cold, or add flavor with fruits like lemon or herbs like mint. Avoid sugary drinks like soda,

sweetened fruit juices, and energy drinks.